STATION 1 HELPER GM — THE LIBRARY (CROWN & DAGGER)

Pair: Fred Jones (Fighter) & Griffin the Invisible Man (Rogue) · **Goal:** place the 6 relics in the right statues' hands → Archive Gate opens → **Crest #1 + Evidence Card E1**. **Target:** 10–15 min. Full rules: `Stations/Station_1_Library_Crown_and_Dagger.md`.

Before the players arrive

- Six statue cards **first-name side up**: 1 Victoria · 2 Alexi · 3 Teresa · 4 Valerius · 5 Borislav · 6 Barov (on a box, he's on a tall plinth). Full titles stay face-down until the solve.
- Six relic tokens (book, scythe, dagger, spear, hammer, crown) **under a cloth "velvet runner"** on the reading table.
- Gargoyle card above the "fireplace"; Spectre standee hidden in your lap.
- **Telling Detail slips 1–6** in your hand, sorted. Envelopes 1–5 in order, Envelope 4 sealed. Phone timer.

Your special job: the Telling Detail slips

- A player inspects a statue → **Investigation DC 13** (Fred +4, Griffin +5). Success: hand over that statue's slip and tuck it under the card.
- Fail: *"Only dust and stone. Try a different approach."* They may retry next turn with a new approach (touch, smell, candle, sleeve). The clue is never locked behind one bad roll.
- **Barov needs no roll.** Any close look (Mage Hand, a climb at Athletics DC 12, or a long stare after Envelope 3) finds *nothing, not even dust* → hand over slip 6.

Station clock

Time	Do this
0:00	Read the Player Introduction aloud. Start the timer.
2:00–3:00	**Envelope 1** when they lift the runner (no roll) or inspect the table (DC 11). Not found by 3:00? The runner slides off by itself.
5:00–6:00	**Envelope 2** (hook prompt) if neither player has used their sheet yet.
8:00–9:00	**Envelope 3** when they inspect a plinth (DC 12). Not found by 9:00? A plinth plate cracks loose: hand it over.
11:00	Stuck, or right after a crown/dagger swap: **Envelope 4**, but speak only the pairs they haven't locked in.
13:00	Still stuck: read all of Envelope 4.
15:00	Lead GM's bell = hard stop. Finish fast, then **Envelope 5** and send them to the Gate.

Answer key (DM eyes only)

Statue	Detail on its slip	Relic
1 Victoria (Arch-Librarian)	Ink on fingertips	**Book**
2 Alexi (the Harvester)	Mud on boots and hem	**Scythe**
3 Teresa (the Traitor)	Crimson-stained hands	**Dagger**
4 Valerius (Admiral)	Salt, brine, barnacles	**Spear**
5 Borislav (Forge-Master)	Soot on jaw and knuckles	**Hammer**
6 Barov (the Spotless)	Nothing at all, not even dust	**Crown**

STATION 1 HELPER GM — RUNNING THE ROOM

Failure rules

- **Placement only:** handling/inspection is safe. An offering to a statue counts; moving a token around the table does not.
- **Any wrong placement:** the statue shudders and *every* relic placed so far clatters back to the table. Sweep them all back yourself, loudly.
- **2nd wrong placement onward:** the gargoyle shrieks at everyone it can see: DC 12 Wis save or 1d6 psychic. **Griffin is invisible and never targeted.** Point that out the first time; he'll love it.
- **Crown ↔ Dagger swap** (dagger to Barov or crown to Teresa): a minor **Spectre** appears (AC 12, 14 HP, +4 to hit, 1d6 necrotic). Fred's Net Trap (DC 13 Dex) plus Griffin's Sneak Attack ends it in about a minute. This unlocks Envelope 4 early.
- **Taboo warning:** before any crown or dagger placement, say *"The gargoyle's eyes flare red. Are you sure?"* Say it **every time, right or wrong**, so it gives nothing away.

Nudges (questions only, never answers)

When	Say
Nobody touches the table (2–3 min)	*"That velvet runner is lumpy. Anyone curious?"*
Guessing, not looking (3–5 min)	*"These are statues of real people. What would a statue remember about the person?"*
Hooks unused (5–6 min)	Fred: *"Your sheet says you love splitting up."* Griffin: *"Barov's hands are way up there. Anything on your sheet that reaches far?"*
Five stains found (8–9 min)	*"What's strange about the sixth statue?"* / *"Have you checked the plinths?"*
Arguing over the rhyme	Give it a minute, then: *"What does a tiller do in a field?"*

Character rulings

- **Fred, "Let's Split Up!"** (station ruling): once here, Fred and his partner inspect two different statues at once, **both with Advantage**.
- **Griffin, "Mage Hand Shenanigans":** inspects Barov's plinth without climbing and can float the crown into Barov's raised hands.
- Accept Fred's **Survival** (mud) or Griffin's **Sleight of Hand** (blood under nails) as inspection rolls on the fitting statues.

Don't

- Don't name an item-statue pair or confirm a pairing before the token is placed. "Try it and see" is fine.
- Don't point at Barov or call him spotless before Envelope 3.
- Don't read the full statue titles aloud or let players see this card.
- Don't open Envelope 4 early because the table is noisy.

Reward (Envelope 5)

Flip the statue cards to show the full titles, then hand over **Crest #1** and **Evidence Card E1**. Say: *"Take these to the Grand Gate. Hurry!"*

STATION 1 — ENVELOPE LABELS (TAPE ONE TO THE FRONT OF EACH ENVELOPE)

ENVELOPE 1 · LOOK AROUND

Station 1 · Library. Open at **2–3 min**, or when they lift the runner.

ENVELOPE 2 · YOUR SHEET

Station 1 · Library. Open at **5–6 min** if hooks are unused.

ENVELOPE 3 · THE RULE

Station 1 · Library. Open on a plinth search (DC 12), or at **9:00**.

ENVELOPE 4 · SEALED: EMERGENCY

Station 1 · Library. **Helper only.** At 11:00 if stuck, or after a crown/dagger swap.

ENVELOPE 5 · REWARD

Station 1 · Library. Open on solve: **Crest #1 + Evidence Card E1**.

ENVELOPE CONTENTS (CUT OUT AND PUT INSIDE)

ENVELOPE 1 · THE READING TABLE INSCRIPTION

Hand this to the players.

> "Six walked before the master.
> The scholar reads while the tiller reaps;
> the smith burns while the sailor weeps.
> The killer's hands are scarlet stained,
> while one sits clean above the pain."

ENVELOPE 2 · HOOK PROMPT (READ ALOUD)

> Fred: "Your sheet says you love splitting up. What if you both checked different statues at the same time?"
> Griffin: "Barov's plinth is way too tall to climb easily... but something on your sheet can reach six squares."

Ruling: Let's Split Up = both inspect with Advantage this round. Mage Hand = reaches Barov.

ENVELOPE 3 · THE PLINTH PLATE

Hand this to the players.

> I. The hand is marked by what it held.
> II. The hand that never worked shall hold what was never earned.

ENVELOPE 4 · GHOST LIBRARIAN'S WHISPER (READ ALOUD)

At 11:00, speak only the pairs they haven't locked in. Full line at 13:00.

> A translucent librarian floats past, muttering: "Give the book to the ink, the scythe to the mud, the hammer to the soot, the spear to the brine, the crown to the spotless one, and the dagger to the blood!"

ENVELOPE 5 · EVIDENCE CARD E1: THE BORROWED BOOK

Goes in with Crest #1. The players carry it to the Gate.

> Tucked behind Barov's plinth: *Spooky Mechanisms for Beginners*, long overdue. The borrower's signature is smeared from right to left, the way a **left-handed** writer drags their hand through wet ink.